How to Do Business With Network 15 Contracting

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Supervisory Contract Specialist, NCO15
General Services Team

Overview

- Supervisory Contract Specialist/Contracting Officer, NCO15

- NCO-15 in Leavenworth, KS

- Responsible for the supervision of a team of Contract Specialist/Contracting Officer tasked with procurement and administration of contracts for general services (e.g., maintenance/repair, janitorial, transportation, etc.).

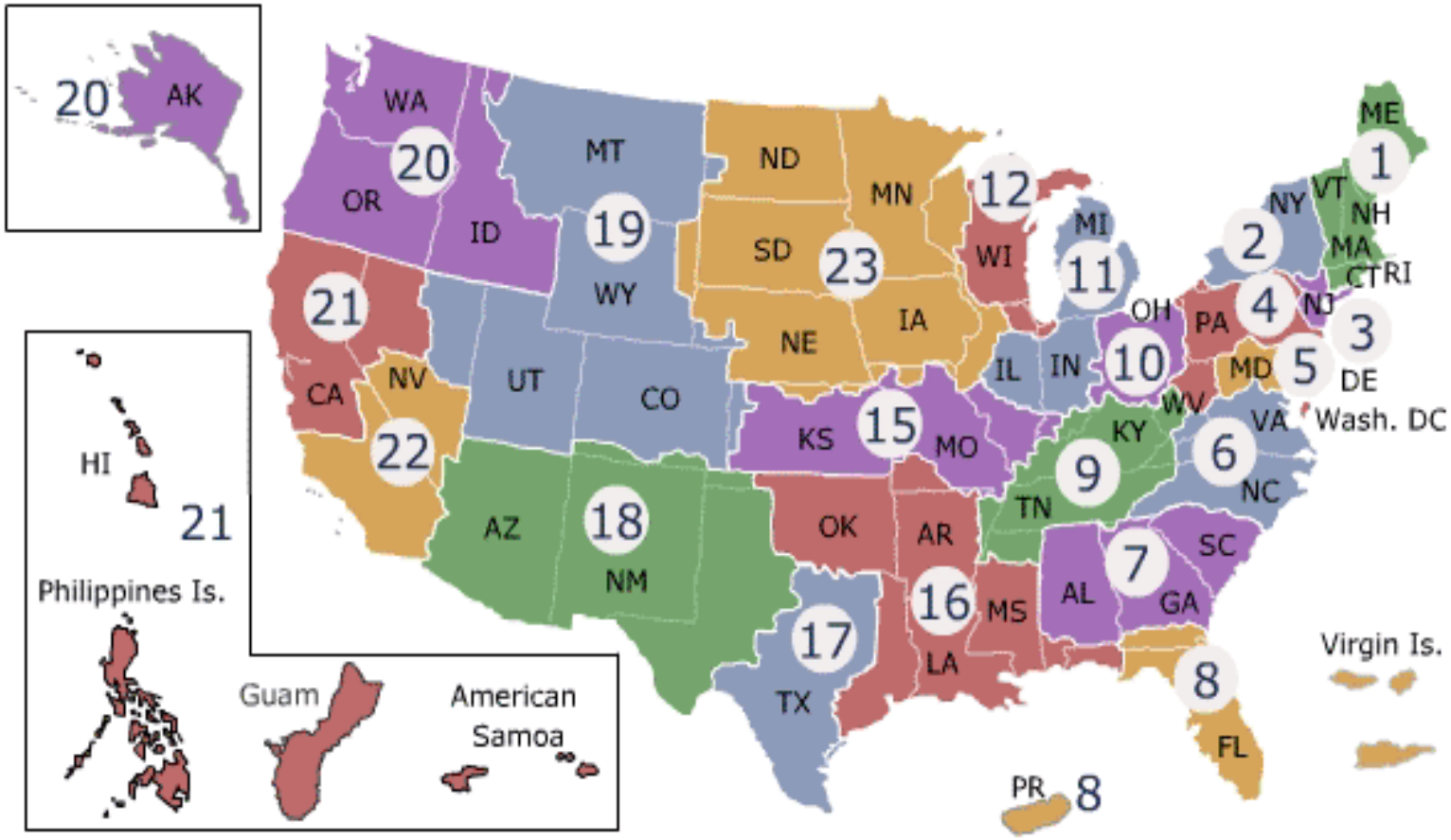
Veterans Administration Mission Statement

To fulfill President Lincoln's promise “To care for him who shall have borne the battle, and for his widow, and his orphan” by serving and honoring the men and women who are America’s Veterans.

Network Contracting Office NCO-15

- Contracting Office located in Leavenworth, KS
- VISN 15: The Heartland Network
- VISN (Veterans Integrated Service Network)
  Providing health care services to Veterans in Kansas, Missouri, and parts of Illinois, Indiana, Kentucky and Arkansas.
  - Eight VA Medical Centers
  - Two Outpatient Clinics
  - Fifty-three Community Based Outpatient Clinics
  - Nine Vet Centers
  - One Primary Care Clinic

Veterans Health Administration Regions



Small Business Programs

- Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business Set-Asides or Sole Sources (Public Law 109-461)
- Veteran Owned Small Business Set Asides (Public Law 109-461)
- 8(a) Reserves (FAR 19.8) **OR**
- Historically Underutilized Business (HUB) Zone Set-Asides (FAR 19.13) **OR**
- Woman Owned and Economically Disadvantaged Woman Owned Set Asides (FAR 19.15)
- Small Business Set-Asides -- Total & Partial (FAR 19.5)

Prime Contracting Goals FY 2015

Small Business 37%

Veteran-Owned Small Business 12%

Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Businesses 10%

Woman-Owned Small Business 5%

Small Disadvantaged Business 5%

(HUB) Zone Small Business 3%

Goals and Accomplishments FY 2014

Category	FY14 Goal	FY14 Final	Total Dollars
SDVOSB	10.0%	20.04%	>$72.1 mil
VOSB	12.0%	24.52%	>$88.2 mil
8(a) / SDB Combined	5.0%	13.01%	>$46.8 mil
WOSB	5.0%	4.25%	>$15.2 mil
HUBZone	3.0%	1.88%	>$6.7 mil
SB	35%	41.74%	> $150.2 mil

Acquisitions and Contractual Authority

Acquisitions and contractual commitments can only be made by Government officials having expressed authority to enter into such agreements on behalf of the United States Government. The ONLY Government officials with such authority are Warranted Contracting Officials. Any discussions of contractual requirements do not constitute contractual direction or authorization of any kind. Future contractual directions, If ANY, shall ONLY come from the cognizant Department of Veterans Affairs Warranted Contracting Officer.

Who Determines Need?

- Requiring Service (Facility, Hospital, etc.)
- Chief Logistics Officer
- Contracting Officer
- Purchasing Agents
- Program Managers

Who are the NCO-15 Teams?

Construction Team	Construction & Architectural Engineering (AE) Services
General Services Team	Services contracts except for construction & AE
Medical Services Team	Professional Medical Services (Physicians, Nurses, Technicians)
Supply Team	Equipment & Supplies, Bread & Milk, Software Licenses, Furniture
Specialty Team	Unique contracting (Real Estate Leases, Selling Agreements, Utilities, Prosthetics)
Purchase Card Program	Streamlined approach to purchasing supplies/services under micro-purchase threshold (currently $3K)
Consolidated Mail Outpatient Pharmacy (CMOP)	High volume mail delivery of medications

What does NCO-15 Procure?

- Pharmaceuticals, medical, and surgical supplies
- Professional Medical Services
- Equipment, supplies, and materials for facility operations
- Maintenance/repair of medical and scientific equipment
- Cleaning, housekeeping, janitorial
- Building construction, A&E services, maintenance/repair
- Prosthetic and orthopedic aids
- Real Property Leases
- Laboratory Equipment
- Nursing Home Services
- Medical gases
- The list goes on….

FY 14 Procurements
NAICS & PSC

Top General Services NAICS Codes:

518210	Data Processing, Hosting & Related Services
515210	Cable & Other Subscription Programming
811219	Other Electronic & Precision Equipment Repair & Maintenance
492110	Couriers & Express Delivery Services
493190	Other Warehousing & Storage

Top General Services PSC Codes:

R603	Transcription Services
R602	Courier & Messenger Services
J065	Maintenance and Repair of Medical, Dental & Veterinary
J066	Maintenance and Repair of Instruments & Laboratory Equipment
S207	Insect & Rodent Control Services

How Does The VA Buy?

- Required Sources of Supply (FAR Part 8)
- Contract Vehicles - GWACs, MACs, FSS
- Full & Open Competition after exclusion of sources (Small Business Programs)
- Full & Open Competition (Open to all vendors)

Mandatory Contracts

- Federal Supply Schedule
- VA Strategic Sourcing Contracts/Blanket Purchase Agreements (BPA)
- NASA Solutions for Enterprise Wide Procurement (SEWP)
- VETS Government Wide Acquisition Contract (GWAC)

Where to Submit?

- Federal Business Opportunities Page
- GSA eBuy System
- NASA SEWP

Before Marketing to NCO-15

Know the basics:

- Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR)
- Veterans Affairs Acquisition Regulation (VAAR)
- System for Award Management (SAM)
- FedBizOpps (FBO)
- Procurement Technical Assistance Center (PTAC)
- Small Business Administration (SBA)

Before Marketing to NCO-15

Understand your customer's needs:

- Be competitive
- Do correct marketing
- Building relationships
- Product, Process, Persistence, Performance
- Be the Best in your field
- Know your product and share your knowledge
- References and Reputation
- Teaming arrangements

Before Marketing to NCO-15

Be a Procurement Ready company:

- DUNS Number
- SAM Registered: www.sam.gov
  - Completed online Reps and Certs
  - NAICS codes certifying Size Standards
- Past performance references (Similar in scope)
- Capability Statement (1-Page)
- Aware of the current market

Before Marketing to NCO-15

Common Mistakes

- Not reading the entire solicitation and providing all documentation.
- Not asking for a debriefing after being an unsuccessful offeror.
- Not updating System for Award Management (SAM) regularly.
- Not using the PTAC as a resource.
- Not learning procurement regulations.
- Don't expect a contract.
- Failing to maintain active registration in the appropriate databases in VetBIZ, VETS-100, etc.)
- Not being familiar with NAICS codes
- Not searching for advertised opportunities
- Not reaching out to the Logistics Department to introduce your product/service
- Providing un-reasonable prices. (We can cancel set-asides when prices are too high compared to the market.)

Before Marketing to NCO-15

What NOT to do:

- Say that you do everything.
- Market without knowing your customer.
- Exceed your capabilities.
- Make promises you can't keep.
- Fill out an incomplete response to a solicitation.

Additional Info & Resources

All VA contract requirements over $25,000.00 for supplies and for services are listed on the VA Forecast of Contracting Opportunities.

https://www.vendorportal.ecms.va.gov/eVP/FCO/fco.aspx

Federal Business Opportunities (FBO) is commonly used for our solicitations so check those sites regularly.

https://www.fbo.gov

http://www.gsa.gov

Additional Info & Resources

Procurement Technical Assistance Center (PTAC)
http://www.aptac-us.org/new/

Federal Procurement Data System-Next Generation (FPDS-NG)
https://www.fpds.gov/fpdsng_cms/

North American Industry Classification System (NAICS)

http://www.census.gov/cgi-bin/sssd/naics/naicsrch

Additional Info & Resources

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Q&A

Questions?